

WooCommerce Block Theme — 3ducation.be

3D-print shop · printers, filament & accessories, workshops · EasyHost Managed WordPress

Block theme (FSE) wp-env local dev SFTP deploy WooCommerce

Context

The client **3ducation.be** is a 3D-printing business selling **printers, filament/accessories, and workshops**. It runs on **EasyHost Managed WordPress (Small)**. We're building a **custom block theme (Full Site Editing)** with WooCommerce, developed locally and deployed to the managed host.

- **Managed WordPress at EasyHost is self-hosted WordPress** — no host migration needed. We install WooCommerce + the custom theme directly on it.
- EasyHost Managed WP Small includes **SSH (so SFTP works), 10 FTP users, and phpMyAdmin** — access is self-service in the EasyHost control panel (no support ticket required). **Use SFTP, not plain FTP.**
- Architecture: **Block theme (FSE)** — `theme.json` + HTML block templates, edited in the Site Editor.
- Dev environment: **local WordPress via @wordpress/env (Docker)** — disposable + reproducible.
- v1 scope: full storefront look **and** all product types — simple, variable, and workshops (workshops modeled as products with stock = seats in v1; real date-bookings noted as an upgrade).

Approach

1. Local dev environment (@wordpress/env)

Create project folder `/Users/margaux/code/3ducation/` which doubles as the theme root.

- `.wp-env.json` — boots WordPress + auto-installs **WooCommerce** (and `wordpress-importer` for sample data); mounts the theme via `"themes": ["."]`.
- `package.json` — scripts: `wp-env start`, `wp-env stop`, and (optional) `@wordpress/scripts` if we add custom blocks later. v1 is block-native — no Tailwind/build step required.
- Prereq: Docker Desktop running. Verify with `npm wp-env start` → site at `http://localhost:8888`, admin at `/wp-admin` (`admin` / `password`).

2. Block theme skeleton (theme root = project root)

- `style.css` — theme header (`Theme Name: 3ducation`, text domain, etc.).
- `theme.json` (v3) — the design system: color palette, typography (fluid font sizes), spacing scale, layout content/wide widths, and element/block styles. **This drives the storefront look.**
- `functions.php` — `add_theme_support` for the WC product gallery (zoom/lightbox/slider) and `woocommerce`, enqueue a small `assets/custom.css`, and register block patterns.
- `templates/` (HTML block templates): `index`, `front-page`, `page`, `single`, `404`, `search`; plus WooCommerce overrides — `archive-product` (shop grid), `single-product`, `taxonomy-`

`product_cat`, `taxonomy-product_tag`, `page-cart` (Cart block), `page-checkout` (Checkout block), `order-confirmation`.

- `parts/` — `header.html` (logo, nav, search, **Mini-Cart block**), `footer.html`.
- `patterns/` — hero, product categories (Printers / Filament / Accessories / Workshops), featured products, workshops CTA, newsletter. Patterns compose `front-page.html` and stay reusable/editable.

3. Design direction (default — adjustable in `theme.json`)

Technical-maker aesthetic: clean and precise, generous whitespace, strong typographic hierarchy, neutral base (off-white / near-black) with **one accent color** for CTAs/links. All centralized in `theme.json` so the client can retune palette/spacing in the Site Editor without code.

4. WooCommerce product setup (content, locally first)

- Categories: **Printers, Filament & Accessories, Workshops**.
- **Simple products** (filament, single accessories), **variable products** (printer bundles / filament color via variations), **workshops** as products with `manage stock` and `stock = seats` (one product per session/date).
- Use WooCommerce's built-in **sample products importer** locally to populate the storefront for design/testing; real catalog entered on the live site later.
- Upgrade path (note only): WooCommerce Bookings / a free bookings plugin for true date/time scheduling of workshops.

5. Deploy to EasyHost

1. In EasyHost control panel: create an **SFTP/FTP account**, note SSH/SFTP host + credentials.
2. On the live site: install + activate the **WooCommerce** plugin, run its setup wizard.
3. Ship the theme via **SFTP** → upload the `3ducation` folder into `wp-content/themes/3ducation/`, or zip it and use **Appearance** → **Themes** → **Add New** → **Upload**.
4. Activate the theme; rebuild catalog/pages on live (content doesn't transfer with the theme).
5. Confirm WooCommerce pages (Shop, Cart, Checkout, My Account) under WooCommerce → Settings → Advanced.

Critical files to create

- `.wp-env.json`, `package.json`
- `style.css`, `theme.json`, `functions.php`
- `templates/*.html`
- `parts/{header,footer}.html`
- `patterns/*.php`
- `assets/custom.css`

Verification (end-to-end)

1. `npx wp-env start` → open `http://localhost:8888` ; theme appears under Appearance → Themes and activates without errors.
2. Site Editor: header/footer parts, templates, and patterns load and are editable.
3. Import WooCommerce sample products; **/shop** grid renders via `archive-product.html` ; product → `single-product.html` ; add to cart → `/cart` and `/checkout` blocks work (place a test order with Cash on Delivery).
4. Test a variable product (variation switching) and a workshop product (stock decrements / sells out at 0 seats).
5. Responsive check at mobile/tablet/desktop widths.
6. After EasyHost deploy: repeat shop → cart → checkout smoke test on `3ducation.be` (or staging).

Open / deferred

- Exact brand palette + logo from the client (default applied now, tunable in `theme.json`).
- Real bookings plugin for workshops if seat-as-stock proves too limited.
- Payment gateway for live (e.g. **Mollie**, common in Belgium) — configured during EasyHost deploy.